26900382 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)

REGULAR EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2026

FIFTH SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG5DSEMMD302 - BIOGRAPHICAL STUDY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Very Short answer type questions

Answer all questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. Write the death place of Thyagaraja. [K] / [CO1, CO2]
2. Who was Pudukkottai Dakshinamurthy pillai? [K] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]
3. Mention one important event in the musical career of Mani Iyer. [K] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]
4. Name the father of Palani Subramania Pillai. [K] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]
5. How did Manpoondia Pillai contribute to the growth of a percussion tradition? [K] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]
6. Who wrote/composed Nava Graha Kritis? [K] / [CO1, CO2]

[1x6 = 6]

Part B

Short answer questions

Answer any **7** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

7. State two major contributions of Mani Iyer to mridangam. [K] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

8. Mention the important stages in the musical development of Dakshinamurthy Pillai. [U] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

9. Mention two aspects of Murugabhoopathy's musical training. [K] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

10. Describe the importance of 28 August 1959 in the history of Mridangam education in Kerala. [U] / [CO3, CO4]

11. Mention two important musical characteristics of Syama Sastri's kritis. [K] / [CO1, CO2]

12. For which period did Vaidyanatha Iyer accompany Kanchipuram Nayana Pillai? [K] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

13. Mention two aspects of the Pudukkottai tradition reflected in his playing. [An] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

14. Name the three disciples who stayed with Palakkad Mani Iyer in Madras according to the Gurukula system. [K] / [CO3, CO4]

15. What was the relationship between Syama Sastri and his contemporaries Thyagaraja and Muthuswami Deekshithar? [U] / [CO1, CO2]

16. Which devotional practice was associated with Thanjavur Narayana Swami Appa at Mannargudi? [K] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

[2x7 = 14]

Part C

Short Essay

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **10** marks

17. Explain Mavelikkara Sankaran Kutty Nair role in preserving and transmitting tradition. [U] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

18. Analyse the rhythmic features found in Thyagaraja’s compositions. [An] / [CO3, CO4]

19. Describe Vaidyanatha Iyer's innovations in rhythm, including his elaboration of khandam, misram, sankeernam and his modernisation of basic talas. [U] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

20. Analyse Dikshitar’s contribution to the preservation of rare Ragas. [U] / [CO3, CO4]

[10x2 = 20]

Part D

Long Essay

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

21. Present a chronological and critical account of Mavelikkara Krishnan Kutty Nair life and career. [U] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

22. Write a detailed essay on the contributions of Thanjavur Narayana Swami Appa to the art of mridangam, covering his technical innovations, stylistic developments, and his role in establishing the Thanjavur Bani. [E] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

23. Examine the tonal, rhythmic and aesthetic qualities of Murugabhoopathy's playing. [K] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

24. Present a detailed study of Mavelikkara Krishnan Kutty Nair major contributions in relation to his career. [U] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

[15x2 = 30]